PREP-RASHAN

A Unit of Prep-Rashan Tutorial

DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS - RASHAN

Answers, Explanations & Elimination Techniques – 20 MCQs

6 November 2026

How to use: For each question you get the correct answer, the concept being tested, a check of every statement or pair, why each of the four options is right or wrong, and four ways to eliminate wrong options – logic, keywords, factual clues and conceptual understanding.

GS-I: General Studies Paper I

Q1. [GS-I | UNESCO Memory of the World – Indian texts]

Consider the following pairs (Text : Associated fact):

	Text	Associated fact
1.	Rajatarangini	Written by Kalhana
2.	Bhagavad Gita	Part of the Bhishma Parva
3.	Arthashastra	Rediscovered by R. Shamasastry

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (c) All three

Concept behind the question: Kalhana wrote the Rajatarangini in Sanskrit around 1148–1150 CE, tracing Kashmir's kings in eight Tarangas. The 700-verse Bhagavad Gita lies in the Bhishma Parva of the Mahabharata. The Arthashastra, linked to Kautilya, was rediscovered by R. Shamasastry in 1905 and published in 1909. All three texts were added to UNESCO's Asia-Pacific Memory of the World register.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ **Pair 1**	Correct.
✔ **Pair 2**	Correct.
✔ **Pair 3**	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – all three match.
(b)	*Only two* — Wrong – all three match.
(c)	*All three* — **Correct – all three.**
(d)	*None* — Wrong – all three match.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Each pair is a standard textbook fact – no trap word such as 'only' or 'first'.
- **Keywords:** Kalhana = Kashmir chronicle; Gita = Bhishma Parva; Shamasastry = 1905.
- **Factual clue:** Rajatarangini: eight books called Tarangas; Arthashastra: 15 books.
- **Conceptual understanding:** UNESCO's MoW programme (1992) has international, regional and national registers.

Trap to avoid: Placing the Gita in the Shanti Parva or crediting the Rajatarangini to Bilhana.
Remember: Kalhana – Rajatarangini; Gita – Bhishma Parva; Shamasastry – Arthashastra (1905).

Q2. [GS-I | Revolt of 1857 – leaders]

Consider the following pairs (Leader : Centre of the 1857 revolt):

	Leader	Centre of the 1857 revolt
1.	Kunwar Singh	Jagdishpur
2.	Khan Bahadur Khan	Kanpur
3.	Rao Tula Ram	Rewari

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (b) Only two

Concept behind the question: Kunwar Singh led the revolt from Jagdishpur in Bihar, and Rao Tula Ram from Rewari in Haryana. Khan Bahadur Khan, a descendant of the Rohilla rulers, led the rising at Bareilly in Rohilkhand; Kanpur was led by Nana Saheb with Tatya Tope and Azimullah Khan.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Pair 1	Correct.
✘ Pair 2	Wrong – Bareilly.
✔ Pair 3	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – two match.
(b)	*Only two* — **Correct – Pairs 1 and 3.**
(c)	*All three* — Wrong – Pair 2 is wrong.
(d)	*None* — Wrong – two match.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Kanpur is firmly tied to Nana Saheb and Tatya Tope.
- **Keywords:** Rohilla descent → Rohilkhand → Bareilly.
- **Factual clue:** Meerut rising: 10 May 1857; Ambala's new memorial cost about ₹594 crore.
- **Conceptual understanding:** The 1858 Act moved India from Company to Crown rule.

Trap to avoid: Mixing up Bareilly (Khan Bahadur Khan) and Kanpur (Nana Saheb).
Remember: Jagdishpur – Kunwar Singh; Bareilly – Khan Bahadur Khan; Rewari – Rao Tula Ram.

Q3. [GS-I | Yanbu – mapping]

Yanbu, a Saudi oil export hub recently in the news for threats from Houthi drones, lies on the coast of the:

(a) Red Sea
(b) Persian Gulf
(c) Arabian Sea
(d) Gulf of Oman

ANSWER: (a) Red Sea

Concept behind the question: Yanbu is in Al Madinah Province on the eastern shore of the Red Sea, about 300 km north of Jeddah. It is the western end of the roughly 1,200 km East–West pipeline (Petroline), built so that Saudi crude can be exported without passing through the Strait of Hormuz.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Red Sea* — **Correct – Red Sea coast.**
(b)	*Persian Gulf* — Wrong – that is Jubail's coast.
(c)	*Arabian Sea* — Wrong – south of the Arabian Peninsula.
(d)	*Gulf of Oman* — Wrong – beyond Hormuz.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** A pipeline that bypasses Hormuz must end on the western, Red Sea side.

- **Keywords:** 'Bypass Hormuz', 'north of Jeddah' → Red Sea.
- **Factual clue:** Petroline: up to 5 million barrels a day; YASREF refinery about 400,000 bpd.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Chokepoints shape India's energy security.

Trap to avoid: Choosing the Persian Gulf because most Saudi oil fields lie there.
Remember: Yanbu = Red Sea end of the Petroline.

GS-II: General Studies Paper II

Q4. [GS-II | Children's right to the internet]

With reference to the online safety of children in India, consider the following statements:

1. The Supreme Court upheld a blanket ban on internet use by children under 16.
2. Perceptual hashing can match an image even after small edits to it.
3. The DPDP Act, 2023 requires verifiable parental consent for processing the personal data of a child.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (b) 2 and 3 only

Concept behind the question: The Supreme Court held that children have a fundamental right to access and use the internet and rejected blanket age-based bans, preferring safeguards. It also wants shared national lists of image fingerprints (perceptual hashes) and web links so that known abuse material is caught on every platform. Section 9 of the DPDP Act, 2023 requires verifiable parental consent for children's data.

Checking each statement / pair

✘ Statement 1	Wrong – the Court rejected blanket bans.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✔ Statement 3	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — Wrong – Statement 1 is incorrect.
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — **Correct – Statements 2 and 3.**
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 1 is incorrect.
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 1 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** A court calling internet access a right cannot uphold a total ban.
- **Keywords:** 'Perceptual' = tolerant of small edits; 'verifiable parental consent' = DPDP.

- **Factual clue:** Australia bars social media accounts for under-16s – that is a law, not an Indian ruling.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Proportionality: restrict no more than needed.

Trap to avoid: Confusing Australia's under-16 rule with the Indian ruling.
Remember: SC: internet is a child's right; safeguards, not bans; hash databases for CSAM.

Q5. [GS-II | Cancer drug trade margins]

Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: A uniform percentage cap on trade margins can still encourage hospitals to stock costlier brands of a medicine.

Statement-II: A fixed percentage margin yields a larger absolute return on a higher-priced medicine.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

ANSWER: (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I

Concept behind the question: NPPA capped trade margins at 30% on 137 non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs. But 30% of an ₹8,000 medicine is far more money than 30% of a ₹2,000 one, so a hospital earns more by stocking dearer brands – a nudge away from cheaper generics. Statement-II is the reason for Statement-I.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ **Statement-I**	Correct.
✔ **Statement-II**	Correct – and it explains I.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I* — **Correct – II explains I.**
(b)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I* — Wrong – II is the reason for I.
(c)	*Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect* — Wrong – II is correct.
(d)	*Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct* — Wrong – I is correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Ask 'why would hospitals prefer dear brands?' – Statement-II answers it.
- **Keywords:** Percentage vs absolute return.
- **Factual clue:** Of 1,024 brands, only 16.5% saw cuts above ₹10,000.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Price caps must be designed with incentives in mind.

Trap to avoid: Picking (b) without asking whether II gives the reason for I.
Remember: Flat % margins reward costlier brands – fix incentives, not just MRPs.

Q6. [GS-II | State Public Service Commission]

The Chairman of a State Public Service Commission can be removed from office by the:

(a) Governor of the State
(b) Chief Minister of the State
(c) State Legislature by a resolution
(d) President of India

ANSWER: (d) President of India

Concept behind the question: Under Article 317, though the Governor appoints the Chairman and members of an SPSC, only the President can remove them – for insolvency, paid outside employment, infirmity, or misbehaviour. For misbehaviour the President must refer the matter to the Supreme Court, whose advice is binding; the Governor may suspend the member during the inquiry.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Governor of the State* — Wrong – the Governor appoints and may suspend, not remove.
(b)	*Chief Minister of the State* — Wrong – no such power.
(c)	*State Legislature by a resolution* — Wrong – no such power.
(d)	*President of India* — **Correct – Article 317.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Appointing and removing authorities differ here – a classic UPSC twist.
- **Keywords:** 'Remove' → President; 'suspend' → Governor.
- **Factual clue:** Term: six years or age 62; at least half the members need 10 years of government service.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Security of tenure protects independence.

Trap to avoid: Assuming the appointing authority (Governor) can also remove.
Remember: SPSC: appointed by Governor, removed only by President (Art. 317).

Q7. [GS-II | Border travel rules for Nepal and Bhutan]

Under the Immigration and Foreigners (Exemption) (Amendment) Order, 2026, a citizen of Nepal needs a passport and an Indian visa to enter India if he:

(a) enters India by road from Nepal
(b) flies from Kathmandu to Delhi
(c) travels by road through India to Bhutan
(d) has flown in via Hong Kong

ANSWER: (d) has flown in via Hong Kong

Concept behind the question: Citizens of Nepal and Bhutan entering or leaving India by land or air need only one identity document listed in the Visa Manual. The exemption does not cover travel to or from a third country, and

a passport plus Indian visa is needed if they have flown from or transited through China, Macau, Hong Kong or Pakistan.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*enters India by road from Nepal* — Wrong – an ID from the Visa Manual is enough.
(b)	*flies from Kathmandu to Delhi* — Wrong – an ID is enough for a direct flight.
(c)	*travels by road through India to Bhutan* — Wrong – India–Bhutan movement stays visa-free.
(d)	*has flown in via Hong Kong* — **Correct – transit via Hong Kong.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The rule targets third-country routes; pick the only option with one.
- **Keywords:** China, Macau, Hong Kong, Pakistan = visa needed.
- **Factual clue:** India–Nepal border is about 1,751 km; SSB guards it.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Open borders need smart checks, not walls.

Trap to avoid: Thinking all air travel from Nepal now needs a visa.
Remember: Visa-free for direct travel; passport + visa if via China, Macau, Hong Kong or Pakistan.

GS-III: General Studies Paper III

Q8. [GS-III | Annual Survey of Industries 2024–25]

With reference to the Annual Survey of Industries (ASI) 2024–25, consider the following statements:

1. It is conducted by MoSPI under the Collection of Statistics Act, 2008.
2. Factories employing 10 or more workers with the aid of power are covered by it.
3. GVA per person engaged grew faster than the GVA of the corporate manufacturing sector.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (a) 1 and 2 only

Concept behind the question: MoSPI runs the ASI under the Collection of Statistics Act, 2008. It covers factories under Sections 2m(i) and 2m(ii) of the Factories Act – 10+ workers with power or 20+ without. In 2024–25 corporate GVA grew 9.28% but GVA per person engaged only 2.25%, so productivity lagged.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✘ Statement 3	Wrong – 2.25% vs 9.28%.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is correct.
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Jobs grew 7.57%, so GVA per person must have grown much less than GVA.
- **Keywords:** 'Per person' vs 'total' growth.
- **Factual clue:** Five States produce over 54% of manufacturing GVA.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Growth without productivity limits wages.

Trap to avoid: Assuming productivity rose as fast as output.
Remember: ASI: MoSPI, CoS Act 2008; GVA +9.28% but per worker +2.25%.

Q9. [GS-III | Energy storage VGF scheme]

Under the new Viability Gap Funding scheme for 92 GWh of grid-scale energy storage, the largest share of capacity is earmarked for:

(a) Battery energy storage systems
(b) Green hydrogen storage
(c) Pumped storage plants
(d) Compressed air storage

ANSWER: (c) Pumped storage plants

Concept behind the question: The ₹14,500-crore VGF scheme (FY27–FY31) splits 92 GWh into 60 GWh of pumped storage, 30 GWh of battery storage and 2 GWh for emerging technologies. Projects are awarded by tariff-based bidding, and VGF-backed battery projects need 40% domestic content.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Battery energy storage systems* — Wrong – 30 GWh.
(b)	*Green hydrogen storage* — Wrong – not a named category.
(c)	*Pumped storage plants* — **Correct – 60 GWh.**
(d)	*Compressed air storage* — Wrong – at most part of 2 GWh.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** India has large hilly reservoir sites, so pumped hydro dominates.
- **Keywords:** 60 / 30 / 2 GWh.
- **Factual clue:** Target need: 411 GWh by 2031–32.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Storage turns daytime solar into evening power.

Trap to avoid: Assuming batteries, the newest technology, get the most.
Remember: 92 GWh = 60 pumped + 30 battery + 2 new tech.

Q10. [GS-III | Storage scheme and rooftop solar]

Consider the following statements:

1. VGF-supported battery storage projects under the new scheme must use at least 40% domestic content.
2. Support under the scheme is awarded through tariff-based competitive bidding.
3. The PM Surya Ghar Excellence Award 2026 won by the Ministry of Railways is given by the Ministry of Power.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (b) Only two

Concept behind the question: The storage scheme requires 40% domestic content for VGF-backed battery projects and awards support through tariff-based competitive bidding. The PM Surya Ghar Excellence Award comes under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana of the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), not the Ministry of Power. Railways solarised 12,495 of 15,868 identified buildings.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✘ Statement 3	Wrong – MNRE.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – two are correct.
(b)	*Only two* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**
(c)	*All three* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(d)	*None* — Wrong – two are correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** PM Surya Ghar is a rooftop-solar scheme – think MNRE.
- **Keywords:** Solar schemes → MNRE; grid and thermal → Power.
- **Factual clue:** Railways: 351 MW against a 424 MW target.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Government buildings can lead the solar shift.

Trap to avoid: Confusing the Ministry of Power with MNRE.
Remember: 40% DCR, tariff bidding; PM Surya Ghar = MNRE.

Q11. [GS-III | How a tokamak works]

Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: In a tokamak, an electric current is driven through the plasma itself.

Statement-II: A purely ring-shaped (toroidal) magnetic field makes charged particles drift and pushes the plasma towards the outer wall.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

ANSWER: (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I

Concept behind the question: A simple toroidal field is stronger on the inner side than the outer side, so particles drift apart and an electric field pushes plasma outwards. To fix this, a current is induced in the plasma; its field combines with the coils' field into a twisted (helical) field that confines the plasma. So Statement-II explains why Statement-I is done.

Checking each statement / pair

✔️ **Statement-I**	Correct.
✔️ **Statement-II**	Correct – and it explains I.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I* — **Correct – II explains I.**
(b)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I* — Wrong – II is the reason for I.
(c)	*Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect* — Wrong – II is correct.
(d)	*Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct* — Wrong – I is correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Ask why a current is needed at all – the drift problem is the answer.
- **Keywords:** Toroidal + poloidal = helical field.
- **Factual clue:** Stellarators make the twist with coils alone, without a plasma current.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Confinement is the core fusion challenge.

Trap to avoid: Choosing (b) without linking the drift problem to the plasma current.
Remember: Plasma current exists to cancel drift – making a helical field.

Q12. [GS-III | Revamped Agnipath]

With reference to the revamped Agnipath scheme, consider the following statements:

1. 25% of Agniveers will continue to be selected for permanent service after four years.
2. All Agniveers who complete six years are guaranteed absorption as regular soldiers.
3. Agniveers who take the two-year extension lose reservation benefits in paramilitary forces and PSUs.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (c) 1 and 3 only

Concept behind the question: The revamp keeps 25% selection at four years and offers the remaining 75% a two-year extension with higher pay and a larger Seva Nidhi. After six years they get another chance to join the regular cadre if willing and selected on objective criteria – a chance, not a guarantee. Those who take the extension give up reservation benefits in paramilitary forces, PSUs and State jobs.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✘ Statement 2	Wrong – not guaranteed.
✔ Statement 3	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 3.**
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'Guaranteed' is an extreme word; selection criteria still apply.
- **Keywords:** Opportunity ≠ guarantee.
- **Factual clue:** Seva Nidhi: 30% of pay plus an equal government share – about ₹11.71 lakh at four years.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Retention changed; recruitment model did not.

Trap to avoid: Reading 'second chance' as 'assured job'.
Remember: 25% at 4 years; extension = second chance (not assured) but no quota benefits.

Q13. [GS-III | NDC-TIA II]

The NDC Transport Initiative for Asia Phase II (NDC-TIA II), under which NITI Aayog and GIZ signed an agreement, covers which countries?

(a) India, Bangladesh and Nepal
(b) India, Indonesia and Thailand
(c) India, China and Vietnam
(d) India, Japan and South Korea

ANSWER: (c) India, China and Vietnam

Concept behind the question: NDC-TIA is funded by Germany's International Climate Initiative (IKI) and coordinated by GIZ. It covers India, China and Vietnam and focuses on decarbonising freight – electric medium and heavy trucks, corridor charging and green finance. Phase II runs from November 2024 to September 2028; NITI Aayog is India's implementing partner.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*India, Bangladesh and Nepal* — Wrong – not covered.
(b)	*India, Indonesia and Thailand* — Wrong – not covered.
(c)	*India, China and Vietnam* — **Correct – India, China, Vietnam.**
(d)	*India, Japan and South Korea* — Wrong – not covered.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Recall the initiative's 'big emitters in Asia' focus – China is in.
- **Keywords:** India–China–Vietnam; Germany funds.
- **Factual clue:** Funding for the regional programme: about €4.04 million.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Freight is the hardest transport segment to decarbonise.

Trap to avoid: Assuming only South Asian neighbours are covered.
Remember: NDC-TIA II: India, China, Vietnam; IKI + GIZ; NITI Aayog in India.

Q14. [GS-III | ASW Shallow Water Craft 'Amini']

The Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft 'Amini', recently delivered to the Indian Navy, is named after an island in:

(a) the Andaman and Nicobar Islands
(b) the Gulf of Mannar
(c) the Sundarbans delta
(d) Lakshadweep

ANSWER: (d) Lakshadweep

Concept behind the question: Amini, built by GRSE Kolkata with over 80% indigenous content, is named after Amini Island in Lakshadweep. It carries the name of the earlier INS Amini, a Petya III-class anti-submarine

corvette decommissioned in 2002. The craft uses waterjets and carries lightweight torpedoes, anti-submarine rockets and sonar.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*the Andaman and Nicobar Islands* — Wrong – not there.
(b)	*the Gulf of Mannar* — Wrong – not there.
(c)	*the Sundarbans delta* — Wrong – not there.
(d)	*Lakshadweep* — **Correct – Amini Island, Lakshadweep.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Lakshadweep islands include Kavaratti, Agatti, Minicoy and Amini.
- **Keywords:** Amini → Lakshadweep (Arabian Sea).
- **Factual clue:** Builder: Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers, Kolkata.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Small ASW craft guard shallow coastal waters.

Trap to avoid: Guessing Andaman because many ships carry Andaman names.
Remember: Amini – Lakshadweep; GRSE-built ASW SWC.

Q15. [GS-III | Space debris – ISRO programmes]

Project NETRA of ISRO, often mentioned with the debris-free space goal of India, is related to:

(a) deep-space communication with probes
(b) a regional navigation satellite system
(c) the first crewed space mission of India
(d) space situational awareness and debris tracking

ANSWER: (d) space situational awareness and debris tracking

Concept behind the question: Project NETRA is ISRO's network for tracking space objects and debris (space situational awareness). Together with ISRO's Debris-Free Space Missions (DFSM) – no new debris from Indian missions by 2030 – it is complemented by private efforts such as Cosmoserve Space's Base 1 in Hyderabad for active debris removal and in-orbit servicing.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*deep-space communication with probes* — Wrong – that is the deep space network.
(b)	*a regional navigation satellite system* — Wrong – that is NavIC.
(c)	*the first crewed space mission of India* — Wrong – that is Gaganyaan.
(d)	*space situational awareness and debris tracking* — **Correct – tracking space objects.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'Netra' means 'eye' – a watching system.
- **Keywords:** NETRA = eye in the sky; DFSM = 2030 goal.
- **Factual clue:** Cosmoserve's soft grippers were tested in Mission EMBRACE (July 2026).
- **Conceptual understanding:** Kessler Syndrome is the risk being avoided.

Trap to avoid: Linking NETRA with navigation (NavIC).
Remember: NETRA = debris and object tracking.

Q16. [GS-III | India S&T Scoreboard]

With reference to the India Science and Technology (S&T) Scoreboard, consider the following statements:

1. It has been launched by NITI Aayog.
2. It covers all 36 States and Union Territories.
3. It shows the Category Normalised Citation Impact (CNCI) of India to be above the world average.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (b) Only two

Concept behind the question: NITI Aayog's S&T Division launched the Scoreboard covering all 36 States and UTs for FY 2021–22 to FY 2024–25, splitting output across academia, government labs and industry and tracking 11 priority areas. India's CNCI is 0.89 – below the world average of 1.0.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✘ Statement 3	Wrong – 0.89, below 1.0.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – two are correct.
(b)	*Only two* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**
(c)	*All three* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(d)	*None* — Wrong – two are correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** A CNCI of 1.0 is the world average; anything below 1 is below average.
- **Keywords:** CNCI 0.89 < 1.0.
- **Factual clue:** Top 10% most-cited papers: 8.5%; Q1 journal papers: 28.5%.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Research is concentrated in a few States.

Trap to avoid: Reading 0.89 as 89% or as above average.
Remember: S&T Scoreboard: NITI Aayog, 36 States/UTs, CNCI 0.89.

Q17. [GS-III | Gomarda Wildlife Sanctuary]

Gomarda Wildlife Sanctuary, where blackbucks are to be reintroduced after about five decades, is located in:

(a) Madhya Pradesh
(b) Odisha
(c) Chhattisgarh
(d) Jharkhand

ANSWER: (c) Chhattisgarh

Concept behind the question: Gomarda Wildlife Sanctuary lies in Raigarh district of Chhattisgarh, notified in 1975 over about 278 sq km. Fifty blackbucks will be moved from Barnawapara Wildlife Sanctuary. Blackbucks vanished from the area by the 1970s due to hunting, encroachment and development.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Madhya Pradesh* — Wrong – not there.
(b)	*Odisha* — Wrong – not there.
(c)	*Chhattisgarh* — **Correct – Raigarh, Chhattisgarh.**
(d)	*Jharkhand* — Wrong – not there.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Barnawapara is a well-known Chhattisgarh sanctuary – the source must be close.
- **Keywords:** Raigarh, Laat and Manai rivers → Chhattisgarh.
- **Factual clue:** Blackbuck: IUCN Least Concern; Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Reintroduction must fix the causes of local extinction.

Trap to avoid: Choosing Odisha because Raigarh sounds like Rayagada.
Remember: Gomarda – Raigarh, Chhattisgarh; blackbucks from Barnawapara.

Q18. [GS-III | Disporum kamakhasiense]

With reference to Disporum kamakhasiense, consider the following statements:

1. It is a perennial herb of the family Colchicaceae.
2. It was recorded in Assam and Meghalaya.
3. Its name honours the Kamakhya temple of Guwahati.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (a) 1 and 2 only

Concept behind the question: Disporum kamakhasiense is a new perennial herb of the Colchicaceae family recorded at Garbhanga Reserve Forest and Laisong (Dima Hasao) in Assam and at Barapani in Meghalaya. Its name joins Kamarupa, the old name of Assam, with the Khasi Hills of Meghalaya – not the Kamakhya temple. It is described as potentially endangered.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✘ Statement 3	Wrong – Kamarupa + Khasi.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is correct.
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'Kamakhasi' splits neatly into Kama(rupa) + Khasi – the two States it was found in.
- **Keywords:** Kamarupa = Assam; Khasi = Meghalaya.
- **Factual clue:** Grows on cliffs under bamboo at 200–1,100 m; up to 180 cm tall.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Infrastructure threatens undescribed North-East flora.

Trap to avoid: Linking 'Kama' with the Kamakhya temple.
Remember: Disporum kamakhasiense: Colchicaceae; Assam + Meghalaya; Kamarupa + Khasi.

Q19. [GS-III | Fusion devices of the world]

Consider the following pairs (Fusion device : Country):

	Fusion device	Country
1.	Wendelstein 7-X	Germany
2.	EAST	China
3.	National Ignition Facility	France

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (b) Only two

Concept behind the question: Wendelstein 7-X is Germany's leading stellarator. China's Experimental Advanced Superconducting Tokamak (EAST) in Hefei held high-confinement plasma for 1,066 seconds in January 2025. The National Ignition Facility, which reached fusion ignition with lasers in 2022, is in the United States; France hosts ITER at Cadarache.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Pair 1	Correct.
✔ Pair 2	Correct.
✘ Pair 3	Wrong – United States.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – two match.
(b)	*Only two* — **Correct – Pairs 1 and 2.**
(c)	*All three* — Wrong – Pair 3 is wrong.
(d)	*None* — Wrong – two match.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** France is famous for ITER, not the laser-based NIF.
- **Keywords:** ITER – France; NIF – USA; W7-X – Germany; EAST – China.
- **Factual clue:** India: ADITYA (1989), SST-1 (2013) at IPR Gandhinagar.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Three routes: tokamak, stellarator, inertial.

Trap to avoid: Linking France with every big fusion project.
Remember: W7-X Germany, EAST China, NIF USA, ITER France.

GS-IV: General Studies Paper IV

Q20. [GS-IV | Ethics – child online safety]

After a cyberbullying case, parents ask you, as District Collector, to ban phones and internet for all children under 16 in schools. What is the most appropriate course of action?

(a) Impose the blanket ban at once to calm public anger
(b) Ignore the demand, as the internet is a right
(c) Ban only the children involved in the incident
(d) Set age-appropriate rules, safe school networks, counsellors and safety classes

ANSWER: (d) Set age-appropriate rules, safe school networks, counsellors and safety classes

Concept behind the question: Proportionality and care go together: the aim is to protect children without shutting them out. Age-appropriate rules, filtered school networks, a counsellor and reporting cell, and online-safety lessons with parents address the harm; blanket bans push children to unsafe spaces and make them afraid to report abuse.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Impose the blanket ban at once to calm public anger* — Wrong – disproportionate and counter-productive.
(b)	*Ignore the demand, as the internet is a right* — Wrong – ignores a real harm.
(c)	*Ban only the children involved in the incident* — Wrong – punishes without prevention.
(d)	*Set age-appropriate rules, safe school networks, counsellors and safety classes* — **Correct – protect without excluding.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Reject options that overreact, ignore the problem, or only punish; choose the one that prevents harm and keeps access.
- **Keywords:** Proportionality, safety by design.
- **Factual clue:** The Supreme Court rejected blanket age-based internet bans for children.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Children who fear punishment hide abuse.

Trap to avoid: Treating public pressure as a reason for a blanket ban.
Remember: Safeguards, not bans – protect without excluding.

ANSWER KEY

Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10
(c)	(b)	(a)	(b)	(a)	(d)	(d)	(a)	(c)	(b)
Q11	**Q12**	**Q13**	**Q14**	**Q15**	**Q16**	**Q17**	**Q18**	**Q19**	**Q20**
(a)	(c)	(c)	(d)	(d)	(b)	(c)	(a)	(b)	(d)